

10% BANGALORE COUPLES ARE ALWAYS BORED WITH MARITAL SEX

How many times do you have sex with your spouse?

		MALE	FEMALE
More than thrice a week	39	52	27
Once a week	34	31	37
Once a month	10	8	12
Only when my partner wants to	14	7	20

SEX DEFICIT

While 52 per cent men say they have sex thrice a week, only 27 per cent women corroborate the fact. The irregularity is huge. One wonders where the men are finding so much sex. In or out of the nuptial bed?

Are you bored with sex in marriage?

		MALE	FEMALE
Never	53	58	49
Sometimes	35	30	39
Mostly	5	5	4
Always	2	2	2

GENDER GAP

Women feel it's high time they had some more sex and fun. Thirty-nine per cent wives are bored with sex compared to 8 per cent in the survey conducted in 2003. The 31-40-year-olds are feeling the seven-year itch with nearly half of them bored of sex in marriage. The Indian bedroom needs some spicing up.

All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/Won't say.

bring happiness in my life."

Most people are likely to file for divorce in their late 20s and 30s, after an average of four years of marriage. During this time, both men and women experience a pre-midlife crisis. In many cases "loss of sexual desire" leads to the first crack in the relationship—the fact that 52 per cent of men feel sex is important in a marriage while 33 per cent women feel the same way is a pointer to the difference. This leads to a disinterest in the relationship for many men. This sexual desire is reawakened in a new encounter outside the marriage. Whether these

encounters involve sex or remain platonic, they are emotionally significant. This is followed by people experiencing feelings unlike they have experienced before. They feel "alive" again and many believe they have found their soul mates. Some of them experience the trauma of choosing between their spouses and new love interests. They believe they are being unfair to their spouses, and yet are unable to end their affairs. Some choose to stay married and continue their affairs, while others opt for divorce. There are others who end the relationship with their lover. Breaking a

marriage is difficult but rebuilding the trust is something even more difficult.

Anita and Rahul came in for marital therapy as Anita was suffering from nerves. She felt anxious every time her husband left the house. After an examination, it was found that her husband had confessed to an affair a year back. Although Anita decided to stay in the marriage, her trust was shattered. She frequently kept a check on her husband's activities and slipped into a deep depression.

So how does one handle the invisible monster in the bedroom? Like all things, first deal with it, calmly and

rationally. Share your emotional burden. Think about the consequences of your decision as they could have major implications. Discuss the issue with your partner. Many times, couples want to fix the relationship as infidelity often happens on impulse. It's great to see couples trying to mend the gaps because marriage is the witness of their love. Once this decision is made, partners should make efforts to remain committed. The victim of infidelity would feel vulnerable at this point. The wayward partner should understand that despite all negative emotions, the partner chose to trust him/her and that he/she should be thankful for it.

It takes a lot of time to fix a broken tie because the damage is irreversible. However, time is of the essence. Spending more time together could in time heal the emotional wounds, especially as the actual sexual act and foreplay don't seem to occupy too much time. Thirty-eight per cent people in the survey say sex lasts only 10 to 15 minutes. There's no need to rush as it's near impossible to repair a marriage within weeks after the discovery of infidelity. Communicating honestly with each other and slowly rebuilding the trust helps overcome the agony. But as they say, precaution is better than cure. Try to cement your relationship when you start seeing the cracks first instead of waiting for it to break down and then create a new foundation all over again.

The writer is a Mumbai-based psychiatrist